ORBIT — PRELIMINARY ANALYSIS

DARK

South Australian Government Procurement — Contractor Analysis

Source: SA Government CKAN Open Data Portal · Period: FY2024–FY2025 (dated records); prior years (undated records) · Scope: 20 SA Government agencies · Generated: 9 April 2026

INTRODUCTION

South Australian Government procurement disclosed in this dataset totals **$3.57B across 2,370 contract records from 20 agencies.** The structure of that spend is radically concentrated: the Department for Infrastructure and Transport (DIT) accounts for **$3.24B — 91% of all disclosed value — across just 634 contracts.** The remaining 19 agencies collectively represent the other 9%.

The dominant activity is capital infrastructure delivery. DIT is running the largest hospital building program in South Australia's history concurrently with major transport works — the Tram Grade Separation, Majors Road Interchange, and regional road upgrades. The top nine contracts by value are all construction awards over $50M. Within this, a small cohort of SA-based and national builders capture the bulk of spend: Built Environs, Built Pty Ltd, Sarah Constructions, McMahon Services, and Mossop Group between them hold over $1.29B.

Beyond DIT, the picture shifts entirely. SA Police spends almost exclusively on **IT and administrative labour hire** — Randstad, Hays, Paxus, Dialog, and Akkodis dominate a $143M total. SA Health's disclosed spend focuses on **clinical reviews, workforce consulting, and pathology reform**, with EY ($7.2M, 16 contracts) as its most embedded advisory firm and Scyne Advisory ($2.6M) handling internal audit. The Department for Education is a heavy **labour hire consumer** ($22M in one contract) alongside digital transformation professional services.

Professional services and consulting total $257M (7.2% of spend) when measured by known firm names. EY is present across 9 agencies and 31 contracts — the most broadly embedded advisory firm in the dataset. KPMG holds 35 contracts across 7 agencies. Scyne Advisory, active across Health, Education, and DIT, has established a meaningful post-PwC position in the SA government market. Labour hire firms — Hays, Randstad, Paxus, Akkodis

> — account for the largest consulting-adjacent spend, reflecting agencies' heavy reliance on contingent workforce sourcing.

DATASET OVERVIEW

TOTAL DISCLOSED VALUE

$3.57B

20 SA Government agencies

TOTAL CONTRACT RECORDS

2,370

FY2024–FY2025 + prior years

UNIQUE CONTRACTORS

1,471

After name normalisation

CONSULTING & PROF. SERVICES

$257M

7.2% of total spend

FY2024 (dated records)

$2.25B

872 contracts

FY2025 (dated records)

$1.07B

443 contracts

Undated records ⁎

$238M

1,055 contracts

⁎ A substantial portion of agency disclosures (particularly SA Health, SA Police, DPC, DSD, Defence SA, and SAFC) carry no start date — they are published as aggregate staffing and contractor lists without date attribution. These records are included in agency totals but excluded from the FY breakdown above.

CONTRACT VALUE DISTRIBUTION

VALUE BAND	CONTRACTS	% BY COUNT	TOTAL VALUE	% OF VALUE	% OF CONTRACTS % OF VALUE
Under $100k	1,388	59%	$45.9M	1%	
$100k – $500k	516	22%	$121.1M	3%	
$500k – $5M	334	14%	$548.1M	15%	
$5M – $50M	107	5%	$1,241.1M	35%	

VALUE BAND	CONTRACTS	% BY COUNT	TOTAL VALUE	% OF VALUE	% OF CONTRACTS % OF VALUE
Over $50M	9	<1%	$1,576.3M	44%	

Nine contracts over $50M account for $1.58B — **44% of all disclosed SA government spend.** All nine are DIT construction awards. The 1,388 contracts under $100k collectively represent just $45.9M, or 1% of value — the long tail of routine operational expenditure. Meaningful supplier analysis begins at $500k: the 450 contracts above that threshold carry 94% of total value.

AGENCIES BY DISCLOSED SPEND

#	AGENCY	CONTRACTS	TOTAL VALUE	% OF TOTAL
1	Department for Infrastructure and Transport	634	$3,240.1M	90.8%
2	South Australia Police	354	$143.4M	4.0%
3	SA Health	362	$85.8M	2.4%
4	Department for Education	349	$64.0M	1.8%
5	Department of the Premier and Cabinet	120	$10.0M	0.3%
6	Department of Human Services	95	$8.5M	0.2%
7	Department of State Development	103	$5.7M	0.2%
8	Defence SA	89	$2.9M	0.1%
9	History Trust of South Australia	28	$1.8M	<0.1%
10	South Australian Film Corporation	67	$1.7M	<0.1%
11	Infrastructure SA	59	$1.5M	<0.1%
12	Renewal SA	31	$0.9M	<0.1%
13	Health Services Charitable Gifts Board	34	$1.2M	<0.1%
14	Essential Services Commission (ESCOSA)	9	$0.6M	<0.1%
15+	Five smaller agencies	27	$0.4M	<0.1%

TOP 25 CONTRACTORS BY TOTAL VALUE

All agencies combined. Contractor names normalised across case and legal suffix variants. FY columns cover dated records only — undated records are excluded from FY attribution. * Joint venture including McConnell Dowell, CPB Contractors, Arup, and Mott MacDonald.

#	CONTRACTOR	CONTRACTS	FY2024	FY2025	TOTAL	% OF TOTAL
1	Built Environs	2	$453.8M	—	$453.8M	12.7%
2	McConnell Dowell / CPB / Arup / Mott MacDonald JV *	1	$404.6M	—	$404.6M	11.3%
3	Built Pty Ltd	3	$29.5M	$295.1M	$324.6M	9.1%
4	Sarah Constructions	3	$187.7M	—	$187.7M	5.3%
5	McMahon Services Australia	16	$125.3M	$39.7M	$165.1M	4.6%
6	Mossop Group	12	$121.0M	$42.1M	$163.1M	4.6%
7	Hansen Yuncken	2	$110.1M	—	$110.1M	3.1%
8	Downer EDI Works	19	$58.2M	$43.7M	$101.9M	2.9%
9	Acciona Construction Australia	1	$97.1M	—	$97.1M	2.7%
10	Bardavcol	9	$35.9M	$33.5M	$69.4M	1.9%
11	Premier Roadlines	3	$54.6M	—	$54.6M	1.5%
12	Hindmarsh Construction Australia	2	$49.8M	—	$49.8M	1.4%
13	LinkSA	4	$45.4M	—	$45.4M	1.3%
14	BMD Constructions	11	$3.2M	$37.1M	$40.3M	1.1%
15	Little Ferry Service	6	—	$38.7M	$38.7M	1.1%
16	Spotless Facility Services	2	$37.6M	—	$37.6M	1.1%
17	Badge Constructions (SA)	1	$36.2M	—	$36.2M	1.0%
18	Kennett	1	—	$33.6M	$33.6M	0.9%
19	Sitzler	2	—	$32.9M	$32.9M	0.9%
20	Bild Infrastructure	2	—	$29.0M	$29.0M	0.8%

#	CONTRACTOR	CONTRACTS	FY2024	FY2025	TOTAL	% OF TOTAL
21	Civil & Allied Technical Construction (CATCON)	3	—	$25.0M	$25.0M	0.7%
22	Randstad	13	$5.2M	—	$24.8M	0.7%
23	Fulton Hogan Industries	6	$1.4M	$23.0M	$24.4M	0.7%
24	Hays	16	$7.9M	—	$23.8M	0.7%
25	Mark Davis	3	—	$23.2M	$23.2M	0.6%

The top 25 is almost entirely construction. Positions 1–21 are infrastructure builders or civil contractors, reflecting DIT's dominance of total disclosed spend. The only non-construction names entering the top 25 are Randstad (rank 22), Hays (rank 24), and Mark Davis (rank 25) — all engaged by SA Police and Education on labour hire.

Built Environs leads with $453.8M from just two contracts: the Flinders Medical Centre Redevelopment ($355.9M) and the Modbury Hospital Mental Health Precinct ($97.9M), both as managing contractor. Built Pty Ltd (a related but separate entity) holds a further $324.6M including Mt Barker Hospital ($289.8M in FY2025). Together, the Built group represents approximately $778M — roughly 22% of total disclosed spend — concentrated in hospital infrastructure.

The McConnell Dowell/CPB/Arup/Mott MacDonald JV ($404.6M) is a design-and-construct joint venture for the Tram Grade Separation Projects. This single contract — the largest by value in the dataset — involves all four firms acting together; individual shares are not disclosed.

McMahon Services ($165M, 16 contracts) and Mossop Group ($163M, 12 contracts) are the most active mid-tier builders by both value and contract count. McMahon spans hospitals, road safety, and regional infrastructure. Mossop is focused on mental health and hospital facility works across multiple DIT projects.

FY2025 shows a pipeline shift. Built Pty Ltd, BMD Constructions, Sitzler, Bild Infrastructure, CATCON, and Fulton Hogan all entered or expanded significantly in FY2025, while the FY2024 cohort (Built Environs, McConnell Dowell JV, Sarah Constructions, Acciona) was dominated by earlier awards. This suggests the capital program is progressing — some major FY2024 contracts are delivering while new packages are being awarded downstream.

Department for Infrastructure and Transport

634 contracts · 327 contractors

$3,240.1M

90.8% of total disclosed spend

DIT is running the most significant concurrent capital program in South Australia's recent history — hospital redevelopments, transport infrastructure, and regional road upgrades delivered simultaneously. The spend profile reflects this: the ten largest contracts are all over $30M, and the top three alone total $1.18B. The department's role as the state's capital delivery vehicle means it acts as principal for projects commissioned by other agencies (e.g., SA Health's hospital builds are procured and managed through DIT).

The dominant delivery model is the **managing contractor** — a construction management approach where the builder manages trade packages rather than undertaking a fixed-price lump sum. This model allocates risk differently from design-and-construct and tends to produce higher headline contract values. Built Environs, Built Pty Ltd, and Mossop Group are DIT's preferred managing contractors across the hospital program.

Beyond construction, DIT procures **specialist engineering and architectural consulting** for project initiation, design, and financial assurance. Baukultur ($17.3M) is the lead architect on the SA Forensic Centre. Swanbury Penglase ($8.5M), Grieve Gillett ($7.7M), and DesignInc Adelaide ($5.8M) are active on multiple DIT projects. Aurecon ($7.8M) and WSP ($5.7M) provide engineering advisory services. KPMG holds $6.5M across six contracts, predominantly for financial auditing of the North-South Corridor project alliance.

Soft facilities management for completed assets is held by **Spotless Facility Services ($37.6M)**, indicating DIT's engagement extends into operational phase asset management post-construction.

TOP CONTRACTORS BY VALUE

#	CONTRACTOR	VALUE
1	Built Environs	$453.8M
2	McConnell Dowell / CPB / Arup / Mott MacDonald JV	$404.6M
3	Built Pty Ltd	$324.6M
4	Sarah Constructions	$187.7M
5	McMahon Services Australia	$165.1M
6	Mossop Group	$163.1M

TOP CONSULTING & ADVISORY ($108.7M TOTAL)

#	FIRM	VALUE	#
1	Baukultur	$17.3M	1
2	Swanbury Penglase	$8.5M	3
3	Aurecon	$7.8M	4
4	Grieve Gillett	$7.7M	6
5	KPMG	$6.5M	6
6	MBB Group	$6.1M	2
7	DesignInc Adelaide	$5.8M	3

#	CONTRACTOR	VALUE
7	Hansen Yuncken	$110.1M
8	Downer EDI Works	$101.9M

#	FIRM	VALUE	#
8	WSP Australia	$4.5M	5

South Australia Police

354 contracts · 95 contractors

$143.4M

4.0% of total disclosed spend

SAPOL's disclosed contractor spend is almost exclusively **labour hire and contingent workforce**. The agency publishes annual aggregate disclosures of agency staff costs categorised by function (IS&T, administrative, project support), rather than individual contract awards. The result is a spend profile dominated entirely by staffing firms, with individual contract values representing a full year of contingent workforce supply across each category.

IT and systems work drives the largest labour spend. Multiple SAPOL disclosures reference "IS&T activities" and "architecture and e-projects" — reflecting ongoing investments in police systems modernisation, records management, and digital infrastructure. Dialog ($9.5M, 5 contracts) stands out as SAPOL's primary IT services firm beyond pure recruitment, suggesting it operates in a more project-delivery capacity rather than simple labour supply. Escient ($5.4M, 5 contracts) similarly holds a position in IT advisory work.

Administrative and operational staffing runs concurrently — Randstad, Hays, and Paxus each hold multiple annual supply agreements covering general administrative, project, and COVID-era support functions. Akkodis ($6.2M) specialises in technology and engineering talent, consistent with SAPOL's IT-led spend profile.

The absence of significant professional services advisory — no strategy consulting, no Big 4 advisory, minimal management consulting — is notable. SAPOL's disclosed advisory footprint is contained: a single EY engagement ($56k) for an HR Management Branch Review is the only named advisory firm outside IT staffing.

TOP CONTRACTORS BY VALUE

#	CONTRACTOR	VALUE	#
1	Randstad	$19.4M	10
2	Hays	$15.5M	8
3	Paxus Australia	$14.0M	6
4	Dialog	$9.5M	5
5	Akkodis	$6.2M	3

TOP CONSULTING & PROF. SERVICES ($92.4M OF $143.4M TOTAL)

#	FIRM	VALUE	#
1	Randstad (labour hire)	$19.4M	10
2	Hays (labour hire)	$15.5M	8
3	Paxus Australia (IT staffing)	$14.0M	6
4	Dialog (IT services)	$9.5M	5

#	CONTRACTOR	VALUE	#
6	Innodev Pty Ltd	$5.7M	3
7	Escient	$5.4M	5
8	Peoplebank	$4.8M	5

#	FIRM	VALUE	#
5	Akkodis (tech staffing)	$6.2M	3
6	Escient (IT advisory)	$5.4M	5

64% of SAPOL's total spend is contingent workforce supply. Strategy advisory engagement is minimal.

SA Health

362 contracts · ~120 contractors

$85.8M

2.4% of total disclosed spend

SA Health's disclosed spend combines three distinct categories: **operational services** (traffic control, pharmacy, clinical supply), **advisory and reform consulting**, and **aggregate staffing disclosures** from individual health networks. The largest single item is Workzone Traffic Control ($11.7M), reflecting the scale of on-site traffic management at COVID-19 drive-through testing sites operated across the network — a legacy of the pandemic response period.

The advisory and reform picture is more strategically significant. **Ernst & Young is SA Health's most embedded advisory firm**, with 16 disclosed engagements totalling $7.2M. EY's work spans three related bodies of work: the Safety and Efficiency Review of SA Pathology (multiple phases, total ~$3M), CALHN workforce modelling and planning ($1.86M across two contracts), and ongoing financial modelling, assurance, and data analytics support. EY was awarded the SA Pathology reform work competitively — a significant mandate and the largest individual advisory engagement in the health sector dataset.

Scyne Advisory holds $2.6M across 9 contracts covering internal audit, ways of working reform (organisational operating model, $1.46M), audit and financial advisory, contract management support, and cyber security review. Scyne's SA Health presence is consistent with its broader SA government positioning — a mid-market advisory firm with a strong audit and assurance base. FTI Consulting ($906k) was engaged for specific financial restructuring work.

A notable feature of SA Health's disclosures is the prevalence of pharmacy service contracts — RGH Pharmacy Consulting Services ($1.05M), Epic Pharmacy, and others — reflecting privatised or outsourced pharmacy operations at regional hospitals including Port Augusta and Whyalla. These are operational outsourcing arrangements, not advisory engagements.

TOP CONTRACTORS BY VALUE

#	CONTRACTOR	VALUE	#
1	Workzone Traffic Control	$11.7M	1
2	Ernst & Young	$7.2M	16

TOP CONSULTING & ADVISORY ($17.4M OF $85.8M TOTAL)

#	FIRM	VALUE	#
1	Ernst & Young	$7.2M	16
2	Scyne Advisory	$2.6M	9

#	CONTRACTOR	VALUE	#
3	Scyne Advisory	$2.6M	9
4	Epic Pharmacy	$2.6M	2
5	Agile Group (Global)	$1.4M	1
6	RGH Pharmacy Consulting Services	$1.1M	1
7	FTI Consulting	$0.9M	1
8	University of Adelaide	$0.8M	3

#	FIRM	VALUE	#
3	FTI Consulting	$0.9M	1
4	Deloitte Financial Advisory	$0.5M	1
5	KPMG	$0.4M	3

EY's SA Pathology reform mandate is the largest single advisory engagement across all SA agencies in the dataset.

Department for Education

349 contracts · ~180 contractors

$64.0M

1.8% of total disclosed spend

Education's spend falls into two distinct streams: **labour resources** and **digital transformation professional services**. The largest single entry is a $22.2M "Labour resources" aggregated disclosure — by far the largest undifferentiated staffing contract in the non-DIT portion of the dataset. Schools Ministry Group ($5.7M) represents National Student Wellbeing Program delivery by a non-government provider.

The **digital transformation and data program** is the most analytically significant part of Education's spend. Multiple professional services contracts reference the Education Management System (EMS) project, an edAnalytics platform, ICT infrastructure in schools, and an Early Learning Strategy — reflecting a sustained investment in departmental data and systems capability. Expose Data ($1.9M, 4 contracts) is the primary analytics and data services firm across this program.

Labour hire (Hays $7.7M, Randstad $5.2M, Paxus $1.9M) reflects the department's use of contingent ICT and administrative workers across both operational and project roles. The Women's & Children's Hospital appears as a contractor ($1.4M) for Early Learning Strategy professional services — indicating cross-agency service delivery arrangements.

Scyne Advisory ($400k across 5 contracts) holds a foothold in Education covering EMS program assurance, procurement review, risk review, and program evaluation — a light-touch but broad advisory engagement consistent with Scyne's cross-government audit and assurance positioning.

TOP CONTRACTORS BY VALUE

#	CONTRACTOR	VALUE	#
1	Hays (labour hire)	$7.7M	1

TOP CONSULTING & PROF. SERVICES ($23.5M OF $64.0M)

#	FIRM	VALUE	#
1	Hays (labour hire)	$7.7M	1

#	CONTRACTOR	VALUE	#
2	Schools Ministry Group	$5.7M	1
3	Randstad (labour hire)	$5.2M	1
4	Expose Data	$1.9M	4
5	Paxus Australia (IT staffing)	$1.9M	2
6	MEGT (Australia) Ltd	$1.8M	1
7	Talent International (SA)	$1.5M	3
8	Women's & Children's Hospital	$1.4M	1

#	FIRM	VALUE	#
2	Randstad (labour hire)	$5.2M	1
3	Expose Data	$1.9M	4
4	Paxus Australia	$1.9M	2
5	Deloitte Financial Advisory	$0.9M	1
6	Akkodis	$0.8M	2

Scyne Advisory holds 5 Education contracts totalling ~$400k — assurance, risk review, and program evaluation.

Department of the Premier and Cabinet

$10.0M

120 contracts · ~80 contractors

0.3% of total disclosed spend

DPC is the most advisory-intensive department relative to its size. **67% of its total spend ($6.7M of $10.0M) is professional services** — a far higher advisory intensity than any other agency in the dataset. The department procures strategy, policy analysis, market research, ICT review, and programme evaluation rather than operational or capital goods.

The largest single engagement is Jacobs Group ($1.7M), contracted to conduct a constraints analysis for proposed battery storage sites for the SA Battery Storage Policy — a technically specialised infrastructure advisory assignment. Malcolm Hyde ($1.3M) was engaged for a review of multi-agency emergency response arrangements — a sensitive governance advisory mandate that would not have gone to open tender.

KPMG ($640k, 7 contracts) is DPC's most frequently used advisory firm, engaged across ICT functional reviews, assurance planning, and emerging issues. **PwC ($375k, 6 contracts)** holds a run of smaller advisory mandates. Square Holes ($574k) was engaged for marketing and communications strategy. Notable individual engagements include evaluation of the First Nations Entrepreneur Hub (Circle), economic impact analysis of Lot Fourteen, and several procurements listed as exempt from disclosure under PC027 — indicating sensitive or cabinet-related advisory work.

Elevate Management Consulting, Gus Commercial Consulting, and Innovation Performance Australia represent the boutique advisory tier — smaller SA-based firms holding project-specific mandates. The $350k Defence supply chain industry attraction engagement (awarded to Innovation Performance Australia) reflects DPC's role in economic policy coordination.

TOP CONTRACTORS BY VALUE

#	CONTRACTOR	VALUE	#
1	Jacobs Group	$1.7M	1
2	Malcolm Hyde	$1.3M	1
3	KPMG	$0.6M	7
4	Square Holes	$0.6M	1
5	PwC	$0.4M	6
6	Innovation Performance Australia	$0.4M	1
7	Gus Commercial Consulting (SA)	$0.2M	2
8	Elevate Management Consulting	$0.2M	2

CONSULTING & ADVISORY (67% OF TOTAL SPEND)

#	FIRM	VALUE	#
1	Jacobs Group	$1.7M	1
2	Malcolm Hyde	$1.3M	1
3	KPMG	$0.6M	7
4	Square Holes	$0.6M	1
5	PwC	$0.4M	6
6	Gus Commercial Consulting (SA)	$0.2M	2

DPC is the highest advisory-intensity agency in the dataset. EY appears on 3 small engagements not shown above.

Department of Human Services

95 contracts · ~55 contractors

$8.5M

0.2% of total disclosed spend

DHS procurement is primarily **technology discovery, program evaluation, and community services delivery**. The largest engagement is Cloudwerx ($1.3M) for planning and discovery work on the Screening Systems Transformation project — a significant IT modernisation program. Security services (Fields Group, $1.2M, 2 contracts) represents outsourced physical security for DHS facilities.

The advisory spend at DHS is modest but strategically focused. DWS ($499k) was engaged for planning, requirements analysis, and RFQ support — an IT advisory function. Gravitate Consulting ($283k) provided developer support (Microsoft Azure, .NET). Community-facing program evaluation contracts (Clear Horizon Consulting, evaluation of Family Violence National Partnership initiatives; Aboriginal Emergency Outreach service delivery support) reflect DHS's social policy role.

TOP CONTRACTORS

#	CONTRACTOR	VALUE
1	Cloudwerx	$1.3M
2	Fields Group	$1.2M
3	DWS Advanced Business Solutions	$0.5M

TOP CONSULTING & ADVISORY ($4.3M OF $8.5M)

#	FIRM	VALUE
1	Cloudwerx (IT discovery)	$1.3M
2	Fields Group (security)	$1.2M
3	DWS (IT advisory)	$0.5M

#	CONTRACTOR	VALUE
4	Iwiri Aboriginal Corporation	$0.4M
5	Gravitate Consulting	$0.3M

#	FIRM	VALUE
4	Gravitate Consulting	$0.3M
5	Clear Horizon Consulting	$0.2M

Department of State Development

$5.7M

103 contracts · ~70 contractors

0.2% of total disclosed spend

DSD's spend is dominated by **ICT licensing and specialist IT staffing**, reflecting the department's role in trade, investment, and industry development rather than capital delivery. Dassault Systèmes ($555k) — the 3D design software vendor — is the largest single contractor, likely licensed for industry capability or aerospace/defence supply chain modelling work. Peoplbank ($412k) and Hays ($228k) provide specialist IT contractors.

Hajdu Consulting ($300k) was engaged for unspecified consulting work. EY appears on three small mandates (change management, strategy, procurement review). The total advisory spend ($2.3M) is spread thinly across a large number of small engagements — no single advisory firm holds a dominant position. This is consistent with a relatively small department without a large capital or reform program driving concentrated advisory demand.

TOP CONTRACTORS

#	CONTRACTOR	VALUE
1	Dassault Systèmes	$555k
2	Peoplebank (IT staffing)	$412k
3	Hajdu Consulting	$300k
4	NEC IT Solutions	$250k
5	Hays (labour hire)	$228k

TOP CONSULTING & ADVISORY ($2.3M OF $5.7M)

#	FIRM	VALUE
1	Dassault Systèmes	$555k
2	Peoplebank	$412k
3	Hajdu Consulting	$300k
4	Hays	$228k
5	Escient	$102k

Defence SA

$2.9M

89 contracts · ~60 contractors

0.1% of total disclosed spend

Defence SA's disclosed spend is small relative to its strategic significance. The agency functions as an **industry facilitation and investment attraction body** rather than a capital or operational procurement agency — its core work involves connecting SA defence industry players with Commonwealth programs and managing defence precinct infrastructure at Osborne and Edinburgh. Accordingly, most of its contracted expenditure is for **research, design, and specialist advisory**

rather than construction or services delivery.

SmartSat CRC ($898k) is the largest single contractor — a space and satellite research cooperative. Birdon Pty Ltd ($411k) is a specialist naval vessel builder and maritime advisory firm. Van Den Berg Design Team ($265k) provided architecture and design services. The consulting footprint is minimal ($238k) and fragmented across small engagements with Aurecon, Frazer-Nash Consultancy, Tonkin Consulting, and Hays.

TOP CONTRACTORS

#	CONTRACTOR	VALUE
1	SmartSat CRC	$898k
2	Birdon Pty Ltd	$411k
3	Van Den Berg Design Team	$265k
4	W-H Commercial	$139k
5	Hays	$79k

CONSULTING & ADVISORY ($238K OF $2.9M)

#	FIRM	VALUE
1	Hays	$79k
2	PwC	$68k
3	Aurecon	$43k
4	Frazer-Nash Consultancy	$19k
5	Tonkin Consulting	$13k

Defence SA's advisory spend is minimal. Its strategic role operates through facilitation and relationship management, not contracted advisory.

CONSULTING & PROFESSIONAL SERVICES — ALL AGENCIES

Includes management consulting, engineering and technical advisory, architecture, IT consulting, and labour hire / recruitment firms. Identified by firm name; does not rely on contract description keywords. Firm names normalised across legal variants.

#	FIRM	TYPE	CONTRACTS	AGENCIES	TOTAL VALUE
1	Randstad	Labour hire	13	4	$24.8M
2	Hays	Labour hire	16	6	$23.8M
3	Baukultur	Architecture	2	2	$17.4M
4	Paxus Australia	IT staffing	8	2	$15.9M
5	Ernst & Young	Big 4 advisory	31	9	$13.4M
6	Dialog	IT services	6	2	$9.6M
7	KPMG	Big 4 advisory	35	7	$9.2M
TOTAL (252 NAMED FIRMS)					$257.3M

#	FIRM	TYPE	CONTRACTS	AGENCIES	TOTAL VALUE
8	Swanbury Penglase	Architecture	4	3	$8.5M
9	Aurecon	Eng. consulting	10	5	$8.3M
10	Grieve Gillett	Architecture	6	1	$7.7M
11	Akkodis	Tech staffing	5	2	$7.0M
12	Escient	IT advisory	11	4	$6.3M
13	MBB Group	Management consulting	2	1	$6.1M
14	DesignInc Adelaide	Architecture	3	1	$5.8M
15	WSP Australia	Eng. consulting	10	3	$5.7M
16	Peoplebank	IT staffing	8	4	$5.6M
17	G-Force Consulting	Building consulting	2	1	$5.3M
18	Hoban Recruitment	Labour hire	4	2	$4.9M
19	Mott MacDonald	Eng. consulting	3	1	$4.4M
20	DFP Recruitment Services	Labour hire	7	1	$3.9M
21	Russell & Yelland	Architecture / eng.	3	1	$3.6M
22	Tonkin Consulting	Eng. consulting	4	2	$3.5M
23	Scyne Advisory	Management consulting	17	3	$3.4M
24	Smedley Technical & Strategic	Technical advisory	1	1	$2.6M
25	Expose Data	Data/IT consulting	6	3	$2.2M
TOTAL (252 NAMED FIRMS)					$257.3M

Labour hire dominates consulting-category spend. Randstad ($24.8M), Hays ($23.8M), Paxus ($15.9M), Akkodis ($7.0M), Peoplebank ($5.6M), Hoban ($4.9M), and DFP ($3.9M) collectively account for $85.9M — 33% of all professional services spend. This reflects agencies' heavy structural reliance on contingent workforce, particularly SA Police and Education.

Architecture accounts for $44.9M across Baukultur ($17.4M), Swanbury Penglase ($8.5M), Grieve Gillett ($7.7M), DesignInc Adelaide ($5.8M), and Russell & Yelland ($3.6M). This spend is almost entirely attributable to DIT's major hospital and infrastructure program — all five firms are engaged directly on DIT capital projects. Baukultur's position is notable: a single $17.3M contract for the SA Forensic Centre (lead project architect) makes it the third-largest professional services firm in the entire dataset.

Ernst & Young is the most widely deployed advisory firm in SA government, present across 9 agencies and 31 contracts. No other firm approaches this breadth. Its largest mandate — the SA Pathology Safety and Efficiency Review ($3M+) — is the most significant named advisory engagement in the dataset. KPMG leads by contract count (35 contracts, 7 agencies), reflecting a broad-based audit, assurance, and advisory practice rather than major single mandates.

Scyne Advisory ($3.4M, 17 contracts, 3 agencies) is building a consistent SA government position post-PwC rebrand. Its SA footprint spans Health (internal audit, operating model reform), Education (EMS assurance, risk, program review), and DIT (alliance audit). Average contract value of $202k reflects a high-volume, lower-margin audit and assurance model rather than large advisory mandates. This is a different positioning to EY's SA Health engagement, which involves substantive reform advice at higher individual contract values.

Engineering consulting ($22.2M across Aurecon, WSP, Mott MacDonald, Tonkin, Russell & Yelland) is the third-largest advisory category. All five firms are primarily engaged on DIT capital projects. Aurecon is active across 5 agencies (10 contracts), making it the most broadly deployed engineering advisory firm. MBB Group ($6.1M, 2 contracts) holds what appears to be construction management advisory on DIT projects — large individual engagements with a single client.

CONSULTING & ADVISORY — TOP FIRMS BY AGENCY

Ranks the top advisory firms for each agency. Labour hire firms are included as they represent the dominant consulting-category expenditure for several agencies. Values shown are across all available contract records including undated disclosures.

AGENCY	RANK 1	VALUE	RANK 2	VALUE	RANK 3	VALUE
DIT	Baukultur	$17.3M	Swanbury Penglase	$8.5M	Aurecon	$7.8M

AGENCY	RANK 1	VALUE	RANK 2	VALUE	RANK 3	VALUE
SA Police	Randstad	$19.4M	Hays	$15.5M	Paxus Australia	$14.0M
SA Health	Ernst & Young	$7.2M	Scyne Advisory	$2.6M	FTI Consulting	$0.9M
Education	Hays	$7.7M	Randstad	$5.2M	Expose Data	$1.9M
DPC	Jacobs Group	$1.7M	Malcolm Hyde	$1.3M	KPMG	$0.6M
Human Services	Cloudwerx	$1.3M	Fields Group	$1.2M	DWS	$0.5M
State Development	Dassault Systèmes	$555k	Peoplebank	$412k	Hajdu Consulting	$300k
Defence SA	Hays	$79k	PwC	$68k	Aurecon	$43k

Advisory market structure varies sharply by agency. DIT's consulting spend is dominated by technical advisory and architecture firms — the Big 4 are largely absent from DIT's top consulting positions, where engineers and architects hold the mandates. SA Health is the opposite: EY holds the dominant advisory relationship, while technical firms are absent. SA Police and Education are almost entirely labour hire.

No single firm holds a dominant position across multiple agencies. EY's 9-agency footprint is the widest, but its individual agency spends are relatively modest outside SA Health. KPMG's 7-agency reach is similarly dispersed and count-heavy rather than value-heavy. This fragmentation suggests the SA government advisory market rewards persistent relationship-building and panel positioning rather than large single-agency mandates — with the partial exception of EY's SA Health and KPMG's DIT audit engagements.

Scyne Advisory's 3-agency, 17-contract position (Health, Education, DIT) is the most striking post-rebrand recovery in the dataset. Starting from a zero base in SA in October 2023, it has established audit and assurance mandates across three agencies in under two years — consistent with a deliberate strategy to reconstitute the former PwC Government Advisory client base under the new brand.

DATA LIMITATIONS

1. Disclosure threshold and coverage gaps

SA CKAN disclosures are made by agencies on a voluntary or partially mandated basis. Not all agencies disclose all contracts, and the threshold for disclosure varies. Small advisory engagements below departmental reporting thresholds may not appear. The dataset likely **understates the volume and value of small-value advisory work** across all agencies, particularly for boutique SA-based consulting firms engaged on sub-threshold projects.

2. Undated records limit FY analysis

1,055 of 2,370 contract records (44%) carry no start date. These are predominantly from SA Police, SA Health, DPC, DSD, Defence SA, and SAFC, which publish aggregate staffing lists rather than individual contract awards. FY2024 and FY2025 figures in this report cover **dated DIT and Education records only** and do not represent the full agency-level spend for those years.

3. No subcontractor visibility

The CKAN dataset records only the prime contractor. In the major DIT hospital and transport projects, managing contractors engage hundreds of trade and specialist subcontractors — none visible here. The market position of firms operating as project subcontractors (particularly specialist trade contractors and advisory firms embedded inside managing contractor teams) is invisible in this dataset.

4. Aggregate rows and name inconsistency

Several agencies (notably SA Health and SAPOL) publish aggregate "total contractors" rows rather than individual disclosures. These have been excluded from contractor-level analysis but remain in agency-level totals where consistent with agency-published figures. Contractor names are inconsistently formatted across agencies and years — normalisation has been applied for known variants, but **residual fragmentation across name variants for smaller firms is likely.**

5. This dataset covers SA Government agencies only

Commonwealth agencies operating in South Australia (Defence, Home Affairs, Health) procure through AusTender, not CKAN. The two datasets do not overlap. For a full picture of contractor activity in SA — particularly for defence primes and infrastructure firms active on both Commonwealth and state programs — analysis must span both registers separately.

▸ METHODOLOGY